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BSO memo points to troubling fiscal challenge

Says ‘business as usual will no longer suffice’ as attendance continues to drop

By Malcolm Gay
GLOBE STAFF

Deep fissures continue to divide Symphony Hall more than seven weeks after the Boston Symphony Orchestra’s board of trustees unceremoniously dismissed music director Andris Nelsons.

An internal memo obtained by the Globe offers an extraordinary glimpse into an organization in turmoil and its leaders’ promise for a prosperous future. Titled “State of the Boston Symphony Orchestra,”

the document describes how fundraising has stalled since Nelsons’ ouster, blaming the downturn on “certain BSO personnel and other members of the BSO community” who are “spreading false and misleading rumors.”

The memo, addressed to the BSO’s nonvoting board of advisors on behalf of board of trustees chair Barbara Hostetter, also provides a detailed account of the organization’s financial and demographic challenges and gives the fullest de-

scription yet of how leaders hope to revamp the symphony for a new era.

The memo is part of a leadership push to move past the crisis that erupted early last month when the board abruptly announced Nelsons would not return after the 2027 Tanglewood season, saying he wasn’t “aligned on future vision.”

His ouster plunged the organization into perhaps the most profound calamity in its 145-year history. Orchestra musicians, saying they were blindsided by the dismissal, have protested Nelsons’ removal, criticizing leadership for a “managerial failure that led to the

crisis.” Orchestras and soloists across the globe have written in support of the Boston musicians. Nelsons’ supporters have expressed their dismay directly to the BSO, and a local petition calling for a fuller public explanation now has nearly 3,000 signatures.

The memo, however, makes the case that change is needed.

“Business as usual will no longer suffice,” it states. To maintain “the BSO’s excellence and artistic stature requires that we put the organization on a solid financial footing.”

In an interview Tuesday, vice chair of the BSO board John Loder, **BSO, Page A5**

Affordable housing faces new obstacle

Future funding in jeopardy with Boston commercial development stalled

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

The newest building slated to get built in Beacon Hill will be a rare thing in the wealthy, historic neighborhood: a 14-story affordable housing development.

As soon as next year, the nonprofit developer Preservation of Affordable Housing and Caste Capital will tear down the low-slung West End branch of the Boston Public Library on Cambridge Street and replace it with a midrise tower squeezed onto a postage stamp of land, with a new library on the first two floors and 119 apartments for low- and middle-income renters above.

It’s the sort of ambitious development that city officials, and many residents, say Boston desperately needs as it wrestles with the ongoing affordability crisis. But after a surge of affordable housing development in recent years, the money that helps pay for it all is set to dry up amid the city’s broader development slowdown. And that could mean less new affordable housing at a time when the city is starving for it.

“The city relies on commercial development to provide funding for affordable housing,” said Matthew Kiefer, a land-use attorney for Goulston & Storrs in Boston who frequently represents de-

HOUSING, Page A6



TOM BRENNER/GETTY IMAGES

Demonstrators rallied outside the Supreme Court on Wednesday as the court was hearing a call to modify the TPS program.

‘The future of my family depends on this’

TPS holders and supporters travel to D.C. to fight for rights of immigrants

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio,
Tal Kopan, and Tonya Alanez
GLOBE STAFF

As the Supreme Court’s conservative majority appeared sympathetic to the Trump administration’s efforts to revoke humanitarian protections for Haitians and Syrians, dozens of Massachusetts advocates rallied in Washington, D.C., on Wednesday to show their support for immigrants who could be affected by the court’s decision.

They hoped that making the more than 400-mile journey to the nation’s capital could make a difference.

“We want to be witnesses to what is going to happen to our futures,” said Doris Landaverde, a coordinator for the Massachusetts TPS Committee and a TPS holder from El Salvador. “The future of my family depends on this.”

Landaverde, who also works with the National TPS Alliance, an advocacy group for TPS holders, helped coordinate buses for about 80 people to travel from the Boston area overnight Tuesday to Washington. She was among those rallying in front of the court’s steps.

Landaverde’s protected status expires in September. **TPS, Page A7**



FINN GOMEZ FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Boston City Councilor Ruthzee Louijeune (center) was joined by state Senator Lydia Edwards (right) before the trip to Washington, D.C.

Fidelity orders Boston workers back to office five days a week

By Jon Chesto
GLOBE STAFF

In a move that could give a much-needed jolt to a downtown still recovering from the pandemic, Fidelity Investments told thousands of headquarters employees on Wednesday that they would need to work in the office five days a week starting in September.

The significant shift, which will essentially double the workers’ commuting days, will bring a significant boost of foot traffic near Fidelity’s current headquarters at 245 Summer St., next to South Station, and its new complex on the waterfront nearly a mile away. The move could also embolden other major companies, especially other financial firms, to follow suit.

“It’s a good sign for Boston overall,” said Tamara Small, chief executive of developer trade group NAIOP Massachusetts. “More and more employers are recognizing the value of in-person collaboration.”

Most Fidelity employees currently are required to be in the office for two full weeks out of every four, essentially 10 days a month. Fidelity started

FIDELITY, Page A6



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Weather and Comics, D5-6. Obituaries, C9.

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The Supreme Court struck down Louisiana’s voting map, finding that lawmakers illegally used race when drawing up a new majority-Black district. **A2.**

AI chatbots must eventually be made profitable, and that means we’re going to pay, writes Tech Lab columnist Hiawatha Bray. **D1.**

Two Jewish men were stabbed and injured on a London street in what police are calling an act of terrorism. **A3.**

Hampshire College, which is set to close, said it plans to sell its campus “on an expedited timeline” to pay off its nearly \$25 million in debt. **B1.**

Red Sox ace Garrett Crochet has been placed on the injured list with shoulder inflammation, the latest setback for the struggling team. And the Sox lost again to Toronto, 8-1. **C1.**

Remembering someone more than a victim

Tears, anger for Emma MacDonald, allegedly killed by her husband

By Brooke Hauser
and Shelley Murphy
GLOBE STAFF

AMHERST — The grandparents of Emma MacDonald were among hundreds who gathered at a memorial at the University of Massachusetts Amherst on Wednesday to remember the 31-year-old mother who was killed last week, allegedly by her husband, Jeffrey MacDonald, at the campus where they both worked.

“Her name was Emma — she was not ‘the wife,’ ” said her grandfather, Ronald Pasterczyk, in between tears. “We used to call her the angel of peace because she always calmed the situation.”

He stood among family who talked about her smile, her dimples, and the last

VIGIL, Page A7



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Sadie Fossati, Emma MacDonald’s daughter, embraced her father, Jacob Fossati.